

MacroSnaps

Data & Stories Audit

Generated March 12, 2026 • Source files: data.json + LIVING_BRIEF.md

This document is a comprehensive reference for every data series, content block, and story type in MacroSnaps. It covers sources, update mechanisms, frequencies, and current state. Use it to answer: what data lives where, how it gets updated, and what is stale.

Data / Content Type	Source	Script	Frequency
Macro metrics (GDP, CPI, Unemployment, Budget, CA, Policy Rate)	Google Sheet	sync_sheet.py	When consensus changes
Market metrics (Stock YTD, 10Y Yield, Yield Curve, FX pair)	Yahoo Finance / FRED	fetch_market_data.py	Daily
Data-void metrics (Equity Vol, Corp Spread, Sov CDS, FX Vol)	No free source	N/A	Not available
Historical chart arrays	FRED / Yahoo Finance	refetch_historical.py	Manually when needed
Commodity prices (9)	CME / ICE / COMEX / Yahoo	Manual edit	Daily (manually)
Per-metric stories (168)	Claude API (Sonnet)	update_stories.py	Daily, threshold-gated
Country headline stories (108)	Claude API (Haiku + harvest)	update_headlines.py	Daily
Global stories (9)	Claude API (Sonnet + search)	update_headlines.py	Daily
Commodity stories (27)	Claude API (manual session)	Manual content session	When prices move materially
metricBriefs / fxRegime	Manual (written once)	None	Rarely

Part 1: Data Series

1A. Macro Metrics (6 per country)

Annual consensus forecasts for 2026. Source of truth is Ralph's Google Sheet. Written into data.json by sync_sheet.py. Updated infrequently, only when forecasts change. The **value** field holds the year-end forecast, not the current live reading.

Important: when a forecast changes in the Sheet, sync_sheet.py updates the value field. You must also manually update the last point in the corresponding _frozen_historical array to keep the chart in sync.

Metric	Tier	Script	Notes
GDP Growth	structural	sync_sheet.py	Year-end 2026 consensus forecast
Inflation (CPI)	weekly	sync_sheet.py	Year-end 2026 consensus forecast
Unemployment	weekly	sync_sheet.py	Year-end 2026 consensus forecast
Budget Deficit	structural	sync_sheet.py	Historical arrays empty for 9 of 12 countries
Current Account	structural	sync_sheet.py	% of GDP (converted March 10, 2026 using IMF WEO denominators)
Policy Rate	weekly	sync_sheet.py	Year-end 2026 forecast, NOT current rate

Current macro values by country

Country	GDP Growth	CPI	Unemployment	Budget Deficit	Current Account	Policy Rate
USA	+2.2%	2.3%	4.2%	-7.5% GDP	-3.8% GDP	3.25%
CAN	+1.7%	2%	6.5%	-1.5% GDP	-0.5% GDP	2.25%
GBR	+1.5%	2.1%	5.0%	-4.2% GDP	-2.5% GDP	3.5%
JPN	+0.8%	1.8%	2.5%	-1.2% GDP	+4.8% GDP	1.25%
DEU	+1.2%	2.2%	3.8%	-2% GDP	+4.5% GDP	2.50%
FRA	+1.4%	2%	7.7%	-4.8% GDP	+1% GDP	2.50%
ITA	+1%	2.3%	5.6%	-3.2% GDP	+0.8% GDP	2.50%
CHN	+4.7%	2%	5.1%	-6.8% GDP	+2.5% GDP	2.75%
IND	+6.3%	4.2%	4.7%	-7.2% GDP	-1.2% GDP	6%
ZAF	+1.5%	3.5%	32.5%	-4.8% GDP	-1.4% GDP	6.25%
BRA	+1.7%	4.2%	5.7%	-0.8% GDP	-2.6% GDP	12%
RUS	+0.9%	4.7%	2.5%	-2.5% GDP	+2% GDP	12%

1B. Market Metrics (8 per country)

Fetches daily by fetch_market_data.py from Yahoo Finance and FRED. All are tier: daily. As of March 11, 2026: 77 of 96 metrics fetched successfully. 19 failures all fall in known permanent gaps.

Metric	Source	Fetch method	Status
Stock Market YTD	Yahoo Finance	YTD % change from Jan 1 close	Active - fails for RUS (IMOEX.ME delisted)

Metric	Source	Fetch method	Status
Equity Vol	Yahoo Finance	Implied vol; 30-day realized vol as fallback	DATA-VOID - displayed as 'not available'
10Y Bond Yield	FRED	Daily series per country	Active - fails for CHN and BRA (no FRED series)
Yield Curve	FRED (derived)	10Y minus short rate	Active - fails for CHN/BRA; fixed for USA/DEU/FRA/JPN in March 2026
Corp Spread	FRED	ICE BofA IG/HY OAS series	DATA-VOID - displayed as 'not available'. No RUS series.
Sov CDS	Derived proxy	Local 10Y minus UST (EM only)	DATA-VOID - displayed as 'not available'
FX pair	Yahoo Finance	Varies by country	Active - succeeds for all countries
FX Vol	Yahoo Finance (derived)	30-day realized vol from daily FX returns	DATA-VOID - displayed as 'not available'

FX pairs by country

Country	Pair	Current value	Last updated
USA	USD/DXY	99.2	2026-03-11
CAN	CAD/USD	0.74	2026-03-11
GBR	GBP/USD	1.34	2026-03-11
JPN	USD/JPY	158.8	2026-03-11
DEU	EUR/USD	1.1575	2026-03-11
FRA	EUR/USD	1.1575	2026-03-11
ITA	EUR/USD	1.1575	2026-03-11
CHN	USD/CNY	6.86	2026-03-11
IND	USD/INR	92.15	2026-03-11
ZAF	USD/ZAR	16.40	2026-03-11
BRA	USD/BRL	5.15	2026-03-11
RUS	USD/RUB	79.1	2026-03-11

Current market metric values by country

Country	Stock YTD	Equity Vol	10Y Yield	Yield Curve	Corp Spread	Sov CDS	FX Vol
USA	-1.4%	~25	4.12%	+52bps	84bps	42bps	5.8%
CAN	+3.7%	~20	3.40%	+121bps	84bps	45bps	5.8%
GBR	+4.0%	~15	4.45%	+74bps	84bps	32bps	6.8%
JPN	+6.2%	~32	2.24%	+112bps	84bps	28bps	8.5%
DEU	-3.6%	~20	2.81%	+81bps	84bps	20bps	6.3%
FRA	-2.0%	~16	3.53%	+153bps	84bps	38bps	6.3%
ITA	-1.3%	~22	3.49%	+149bps	84bps	70bps	6.3%
CHN	+2.7%	~13	2.40%	+35bps	162bps	72bps	3.2%
IND	-9.8%	~21	6.73%	+123bps	162bps	261bps	7.2%

Country	Stock YTD	Equity Vol	10Y Yield	Yield Curve	Corp Spread	Sov CDS	FX Vol
ZAF	+1.1%	~29	8.62%	+187bps	162bps	450bps	17.2%
BRA	+14.8%	~22	13.80%	-140bps	162bps	180bps	10.5%
RUS	+5.0%	~32	13.5%	-140bps	380bps	320bps	15.0%

Equity Vol, Corp Spread, Sov CDS, and FX Vol are all data-void. Values shown are placeholders. All four display as 'not available' in the UI.

1C. Historical Chart Data (_frozen_historical)

Populated by `refetch_historical.py` from FRED and Yahoo Finance. Updated manually when needed, not daily. Never edit by hand. Each metric has 7 data points: 2020-2025 actuals plus the 2026F forecast as the final point.

WARNING: Running `refetch_historical.py` overwrites Current Account arrays with raw dollar values, undoing the % of GDP conversion. Must re-run the CA conversion after any refetch.

Country	Charts populated	Known gaps
USA	14/14	None
CAN	14/14	Budget Deficit array empty
GBR	14/14	Budget Deficit array empty
JPN	14/14	None
DEU	14/14	Budget Deficit array empty
FRA	14/14	Budget Deficit array empty
ITA	14/14	None
CHN	11/14	Unemployment, 10Y Bond Yield, Yield Curve: no free source. Budget Deficit empty.
IND	11/14	Unemployment, 10Y Bond Yield, Yield Curve: no free source. Budget Deficit empty.
ZAF	12/14	Unemployment: no monthly source. Budget Deficit empty.
BRA	12/14	10Y Bond Yield, Yield Curve: no free source. Budget Deficit empty.
RUS	10/14	GDP Growth, Unemployment data discontinued post-2022 sanctions. Budget Deficit empty.

Data quality flag: IND 2025 GDP Growth (16.77) and ZAF 2025 GDP Growth (6.76) likely reflect nominal USD growth from FRED rather than real % growth. Pending investigation. Budget Deficit historical arrays are intentionally empty for 9 countries: a single forecast point with no history would be meaningless as a chart.

1D. Commodities (9 items)

Source: CME, ICE, COMEX, CBOT, Yahoo Finance. Updated manually each day as part of the daily content session. To update: edit price, change, and spark array in `data.json` (drop first value, append new close), then run `build.py`.

Commodity	Symbol	Category	Unit	Current price	Last updated
WTI Crude	CL	Energy	\$/bbl	103.0	Mar 10, 2026
Brent Crude	BZ	Energy	\$/bbl	109.0	Mar 10, 2026
Natural Gas	NG	Energy	\$/mmBtu	4.5	Mar 10, 2026
Gold	GC	Metals	\$/oz	5,080	Mar 10, 2026
Silver	SI	Metals	\$/oz	81.0	Mar 10, 2026
Copper	HG	Metals	\$/lb	5.0	Mar 10, 2026
Wheat	ZW	Agriculture	cents/bu	622	Mar 10, 2026
Corn	ZC	Agriculture	cents/bu	472	Mar 10, 2026
Soybeans	ZS	Agriculture	cents/bu	1,080	Mar 10, 2026

Part 2: Stories and Headlines

2A. Per-Metric Stories (168 total)

12 countries x 14 metrics x 3 audience levels = 168 story blocks. Each story lives inside its metric entry in data.json. Stories appear in the metric tooltip between the value and the chart. All 168 are complete as of March 11, 2026.

Property	Detail
How created	update_stories.py diffs data.json against last git commit, identifies metrics past threshold, calls Claude API (Sonnet), rewrites at all 3 levels
When to run	After sync_sheet.py --apply and after fetch_market_data.py. Step 5 of daily bash ritual.
Data-void metrics	Equity Vol, Corp Spread, Sov CDS, FX Vol stories not maintained (moving to 'not available')
Beginner length	2-3 sentences. No jargon. Plain English explanation for everyday life.
Moderate length	3-4 sentences. One piece of context (historical, regional, or causal).
Expert length	4-5 sentences. Specific numbers, directional signal, one forward-looking implication.
Status	All 168 complete as of March 11, 2026. Significant drift backlog exists (see table below).

Known value/story drift (as of March 12, 2026)

These metrics have live values that have moved since their stories were last written. Run update_stories.py after applying pending sheet changes to clear this backlog automatically.

Country	Metric	Current value	Story references
USA	Stock Market YTD	-1.4%	~+2%
USA	Equity Vol (VIX)	~25	~16
USA	10Y Bond Yield	4.12%	4.28%
USA	Yield Curve	+52bps	+8bps
USA	USD/DXY	99.2	104.2
USA	FX Vol	5.8%	8.5%
CAN	Stock Market YTD	+3.7%	6.8%
CAN	10Y Bond Yield	3.40%	check story
CAN	Yield Curve	+121bps	+30bps
CAN	CAD/USD	0.74	check story
CAN	FX Vol	5.2%	7.2%
GBR	Stock Market YTD	+4.0%	check story
GBR	10Y Bond Yield	4.45%	check story
GBR	Yield Curve	+74bps	check story
GBR	GBP/USD	1.34	check story
JPN	Equity Vol	~32	check story
JPN	10Y Bond Yield	2.24%	check story

Country	Metric	Current value	Story references
JPN	Yield Curve	+112bps	check story
JPN	USD/JPY	158.8	check story
DEU	Stock Market YTD	-3.6%	check story
DEU	10Y Bond Yield	2.81%	check story
DEU	Yield Curve	+81bps	check story
DEU	EUR/USD	1.1575	check story
FRA	Stock Market YTD	-2.0%	check story
FRA	10Y Bond Yield	3.53%	check story
FRA	Yield Curve	+153bps	check story
ITA	Stock Market YTD	-1.3%	check story
ITA	10Y Bond Yield	3.49%	check story
ITA	Yield Curve	+149bps	check story
CHN	Stock Market YTD	+2.7%	check story
CHN	USD/CNY	6.86	check story
IND	Stock Market YTD	-9.8%	check story
IND	10Y Bond Yield	6.73%	check story
IND	Yield Curve	+123bps	check story
IND	Sov CDS	261bps	check story
IND	USD/INR	92.15	check story
ZAF	Stock Market YTD	+1.1%	check story
ZAF	Equity Vol	~29	check story
ZAF	10Y Bond Yield	8.62%	check story
ZAF	Yield Curve	+187bps	check story
ZAF	Sov CDS	450bps	check story
ZAF	USD/ZAR	16.40	check story
BRA	Stock Market YTD	+14.8%	check story
BRA	USD/BRL	5.15	check story
RUS	USD/RUB	79.1	check story

2B. Country-Level Headline Stories (12 countries)

Each country has a stories block with 3 bullet points per level (beginner, moderate, expert). These are the top-of-card narrative bullets on each country panel. 12 countries x 3 bullets x 3 levels = 108 text blocks total.

Property	Detail
Script	update_headlines.py
Phase 1	Single Sonnet + web search harvest call pulls recent macro data for all 12 countries (capped at 2 search turns, 1500 max tokens)
Phase 2	3 Haiku batches (4 countries each) write story bullets. Recent data leads, forecast values are background context only.
Review step	Writes draft to stories_draft_YYYY-MM-DD.json. Review in headline_review.html browser tool. Apply with: python3 update_headlines.py --apply stories_approved_YYYY-MM-DD.json
Update frequency	Daily (Step 6 of daily bash ritual)
Status	All 12 countries complete. Last full run: March 12, 2026 (first successful two-phase run, 13/13 calls successful)

2C. Global Stories (3 slots, 9 text blocks)

Three top-of-page story cards that frame the global macro picture for the day. Each slot has 3 levels (beginner, moderate, expert). Same update_headlines.py pipeline, runs first before country stories to avoid Sonnet rate limit exhaustion.

Slot	Role	Current title (March 12, 2026)
Slot 1	Today's Story: dominant macro event of the day	Iran Crisis Shuts Key Oil Route
Slot 2	Biggest Movers: markets, currencies, or economies reacting	(updated daily)
Slot 3	The Connection: ties slots 1 and 2 together, the 'so what'	(updated daily)

All three levels (beginner, moderate, expert) tell the same three-act arc at different depths. The icon and label are identical across levels. This formula is enforced in the build_global_system() prompt in update_headlines.py.

2D. Commodity Stories (9 commodities, 27 text blocks)

Each commodity has a story block with beginner, moderate, and expert narrative. These are written manually using the Commodities Session Prompt (Part 1C of LIVING_BRIEF.md). Not automated.

Property	Detail
How created	Manual Claude session using Commodities Session Prompt. Rewrites when prices move materially (roughly 5%+ for most, 10%+ for Natural Gas).
Update frequency	As needed, not daily. Last updated: March 10, 2026.
Beginner length	2-3 sentences. What this commodity is and why its price matters to ordinary people.
Moderate length	3-4 sentences. One driver of current price level and one downstream effect.
Expert length	4-5 sentences. Specific price, directional trend, supply/demand driver, one forward implication.

2E. metricBriefs and fxRegime Descriptions

Each country has a metricBriefs object with a short explanatory sentence for each of its 14 metrics (what is this metric, in plain English). Each country also has a fxRegime object describing its foreign exchange policy at three levels. Both are definitional and rarely change.

Content type	What it is	Update frequency	Status
metricBriefs	Short plain-English 'what is this metric' blurb per metric, appears in tooltip	Rarely (definitional)	Complete for all 12 countries
fxRegime	3-level description of a country's FX policy regime (beginner / moderate / expert)	Only if a country changes its FX regime	Complete for all 12 countries